MINERVA UNIVERSITY

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Capstone Handbook 2025-2026

Frequently Used Links

📌 Permanent link the Capstone Handbook: https://mnrva.link/cp-handbook
📌 Within this google doc, the CP193 & CP194 schedule overview has links to assignment instructions.
📌 Within this google doc, the list of updates
📌 The Learning outcomes for capstone: https://mnrva.link/cp-learning-outcomes
📌 On my.minerva the section of capstone resources
📌 Each time you update your abstract in your capstone, please update your academic abstract in this form
📌 You can contact the Capstone Head Instructor, Prof. Sheskin, at msheskin@minerva.edu.
📌 Organizing Coworking Sessions: https://mnrva.link/cp-coworking-sheet

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Four Parts of a Minerva Capstone

In Year 1, you took the exact same courses as every other Minerva student, and learned the exact same content (HCs). In Years 2 and 3, you took different courses with varying Learning Outcomes (LOs). Over your Minerva journey, you have also had a unique mix of experiences (civic projects, summer internships, volunteer work, etc.). Now, in Year 4, you will use what you have learned on your Minerva journey to complete a Capstone Project of professional quality. This is also an opportunity to deepen your knowledge and skills in ways that are relevant to your post-Minerva goals. Your project may look very different from other students' projects, depending on your major(s), interests, and goals.

There are four parts to a completed capstone project:

1. **Executive Summary and Academic Abstract.** The executive summary is a single page, includes at least one visual element, and is for a general audience (e.g., your family and friends). Distinct from this, on a second page, the Academic Abstract is very brief (maximum 250 words), has no pictures, might include jargon, and has an academic audience (e.g., the professor advising your capstone).
2. **Capstone Work Product.** This is highly variable, but is generally a "real-world" work product with a real-world audience (or it will be picture/text documentation of a work product that cannot easily be in a PDF – such as a theatrical performance).
3. **Capstone Process Documentation.** This will usually be the longest part of your capstone project, and is a "behind the scenes" guide to how you did your capstone work product. It includes a description of your project navigation, how you used HCs and LOs and other learning, and may also include substantial work that was not part of your final curated work product.
4. **Manifest Capstone Class.** In May, you will create and lead a class on your capstone, attend other students' classes about their capstones, and attend some related events put together by Minerva staff.

Part 1: Executive Summary and Academic Abstract

Executive Summary

The Executive Summary is a 1-page document that introduces your capstone for a *general* audience. Imagine a friend or family member outside of Minerva, who wants to learn about your capstone in about 10 minutes, and has no particular background in your topic. What text and pictures would you put on a single page for them to look at? This will also be the main pre-class reading when you lead your Manifest class session for your peers, so you should think of them as your #audience as well.

Even though it is only one page long, you should expect to spend substantial time crafting the Executive Summary. It will be the only exposure many people have to your capstone! You can try out different approaches and experiment with ideas from how people construct blog posts, visual abstracts, graphical abstracts, and more! No matter what form it takes, it should include:

- Title of the project and your name
- The most important and cohesive content from your capstone, but probably not everything (#curation)
- Clear #organization (examples: section titles, bolding, and bullet points)
- At least one helpful visual element (flowchart, diagram, photograph, etc.)
- Straightforward language (words and grammar you expect a new Year 1 Minerva student would know)
- Easy readability without "crowding" (you should have a reasonable font size, margins, etc.)

Academic Abstract

The #audience for your academic abstract is the professor advising your capstone project, and other people with some background in your subject matter. If you compare the executive summary and the academic abstract, you might imagine an incoming Year 1 student as the #audience for your Executive Summary, but you might imagine a senior in your major as the #audience for your academic abstract. This means that, in your academic abstract, you can assume some background knowledge and you can use common jargon from your field of study.

The maximum word count for the academic abstract is 250 words, and you should probably target 150-200 words as your goal. Please update your abstract text in this form and check that all other information is as accurate as possible. This information will be included in the Capstone project database.

Part 2: Capstone Work Product

This is the most variable part of the capstone project, and your capstone advisor will have specific guidance here about what should be included. Example Capstone Work Products could include:

- A scientific manuscript drafted according to the formatting requirements of a specific journal
- A slide deck and script for a 20-minute presentation to convince a city council of a public policy

- A photobook of 50 images and explanatory text that documents a theatrical performance you directed

Note that, starting with M26, we are more clearly separating the “narrow” Capstone Work Product with its real-world #audience, from all of the Process that led you to make it. One goal is to allow you to produce a very focused Capstone Work Product in whatever form makes the most sense. As an example, imagine a student whose capstone is a public policy proposal. They might have:

- **Work Product**: A slide deck and script for a 20-minute presentation to convince a city council of a public policy, with no mention of academic information such as HCs or LOs (the city council does not know any of this Minerva jargon!).
- **Process Documentation**: A large amount of information about the work that was done to produce the work product, including HC/LO applications, #navigation strategies, a large literature review that contributed to crafting the policy proposal, etc.

Keep in mind that the work product should be an appropriate *capstone* for your Minerva experience. We use the word *capstone* at Minerva so much that you might not have in mind the source of the word. The horizontal rock at the top of this picture is a literal capstone:

(a literal capstone; picture from this source)

Just as the literal capstone sits on top of the other stones and could not exist there without their support, *your* capstone work product should sit atop what you have learned at Minerva, and should not be possible without what you learned. One way we formalize this is by requiring you to use a minimum number of LOs from your major(s), but that is merely a formalization so we can have clear policies for everyone. This means you should not only focus on using a minimum number of LOs, you should also keep in mind the actual goal: your capstone should *be* a capstone, supported in clear ways by many parts of your Minerva journey.

Another important part of the word *capstone* is that we can point to many examples in the real world. Getting a heavy stone high into the air is a difficult achievement, but it is something that many people have achieved, using well-established methods. You can see the wikipedia page for Dolmen that has an entire gallery of images like the one above. In general, you should expect your Minerva

capstone to be a large effort, but one that is a reasonable scope and uses a lot of established approaches to lead to an outcome similar to projects other people have done. Your capstone should show you can do a project of professional quality related to your major(s), not of unprecedented quality never-before-seen on the planet.

Part 3: Capstone Process Documentation

This will likely be the longest part of the PDF you upload to Forum, and you should think carefully about how to best organize and present the information in it. Here are some (not all!) of the questions someone should be able to answer after reading your Process Documentation:

- How was this project different and better because of the HCs and LOs you learned, compared to what you would have produced without that content?
- Across the past year, what project management techniques and tools did you use to produce this work? How did your process compare to the process used by people doing similar projects for their career?
- Which parts of your #navigation worked well for you, and what would you change if you did a similar project in the future?
- What challenges did you face, and how did you overcome them?
- What additional learning did you do that is not directly visible in the work product itself (e.g., an academic literature review that supported you creating the work product, without being part of the work product itself)?
- How did you *wisely* make use of sources of potential (mis)information, such as informational interviews, information posted online, academic literature, generative AI, and casual discussion with people in your social network?

Here is a suggested list of sections you will almost certainly include, but not a complete list of all the sections you will include (which varies across capstones and processes):

- **Overview.** Help orient your reader to the content in your large *Process Documentation* that follows, making sure you highlight the parts you are proudest of.
- **Modeling professional process.** What did you learn about the process that people often use to create work products similar to yours? Which were a good fit for your capstone, goals and situation? When did you do something different?
- **Use of Generative AI.** This is a more specific topic within “modeling professional process” because many people doing real-world projects use AI in various ways. If you do not use generative AI at all while working on your capstone, then that should be described: what are ways you *might* have chosen to use AI, but did not? On the other hand, if you did use AI, you should describe how you used it. The level of detail and analysis here should be high. For example, you might include sections of discussions you had with AI, annotated with your analysis of how you reflected on and used the ideas brought up in the chat.
- **Strategies for #navigation.** Refer to materials from CP191 and CP192 about this capstone-specific LO, for example the list of questions (in the LO documentation) that includes “How have you dealt with setbacks?” and “Have you employed appropriate strategies and mindsets”.

- **HC/LO Reflection.** This section will likely appear directly before your full list of HCs and LOs with descriptions of how you used them. What are the take-home messages you want someone to leave with after seeing your HC and LO descriptions. For example, did the most important HC for your work end up being one that you did not expect would be useful at first?
- **HC Descriptions.** You should describe in detail how you applied 15-25 HCs, and that list should definitely include #professionalism and #organization.
- **LO Descriptions.** You should describe in detail how you applied the 4 Capstone LOs (#qualitydeliverables, #curation, #navigation, #outcomeanalysis), plus at least 5 LOs from any of the colleges. You must use 2 LOs from each major you have. If you have multiple majors, you need at least 2 from each. Custom LOs do count towards this total. For example, a BZ major would need at least 2 from the BZ college, plus 3 others (from BZ or any other college); a BZ and AH major would need at least 2 from BZ and at least 2 from AH, and 1 from any college (BZ, AH, or any other college).
- **Timeline.** Whether a Gantt Chart or a calendar or a list or anything else, you should show some information about when your work happened. One possibility is that you show early plans, how you revised them over time, and the final reality.

At all times, the person reading your *Process Navigation* should be guided by you in their understanding of your process.

- For example, perhaps an early step in your process was writing a lot of ideas on a piece of paper, and you show a photograph of that paper in your *Process Navigation*. In addition to the photograph itself, you might provide context ("Free associating on paper has worked for me well in the past, including big assignments in high school and brainstorming goals for where I applied to college"), a typed-up version of the words on the photograph that are easier for someone to read ("This next figure replaces my handwriting with computer text, to be easier to read") and analysis ("It is notable that the major direction my capstone took was a note scribbled at the edge of the paper, and the large amount I wrote first and near the center ended up being a dead end.").
- Another example is the HC/LO Reflection that is strongly recommended above. Before providing a reader with a long list of HCs and diving into details on each one, you are providing take-home messages for the long list and details.
- As a third example, consider the instructions above for documenting use of generative AI. A student who accumulated 200,000 words of chat with ChatGPT should not merely paste those words into the PDF (and/or provide a permanent link to it stored somewhere) but instead should provide commentary and analysis.

One way to think about this is that your *Process Documentation* should not expect your reader to see your "raw" documentation and understand what it is and what it means. You should imagine it more like a "show and tell" presentation in which you hold up things and talk about them.

Part 4: Manifest

This is a separate 2-credit course (CP195) contained within the month of May, after you have submitted your final capstone. Please refer to the Manifest Handbook for information.

How You Will Complete Your Capstone

The Two-year Capstone process

Note: The below descriptions of CP191 and CP192 are accurate for what the M27 students are experiencing during 2025-2026, and are a bit different from what the M26 students experienced last year.

- **CP191 (Year 3, Fall Semester, 2 credits).** Including readings, assignments, and a weekly meeting, this class will take about 6 hours/week. After a brief introduction to capstone, this semester focuses on general project management skills. These skills will be useful for capstone, but are generalizable to many other substantial projects.
- **CP192 (Year 3, Spring Semester, 2 credits).** Like the first semester, expect this to take about 6 hours per week, including a weekly meeting. This semester is focused on identifying your capstone project for senior year. Most of the semester will be spent learning about available capstone tracks, and developing at least one idea (that may or may not match a track). At the end of the semester, you will *either* fill out the Capstone Track Matching survey *or* submit a full capstone proposal to go off track.
- **CP193 (Year 4, Fall Semester, 4 credits).** Please see the Weekly Calendar below for the content of this course. You should expect to spend 12 hours per week on capstone, but what you do each week will vary a lot depending on the schedule and your capstone. By the end of the semester, you should have a draft of your capstone and a concrete plan to finalize it by the deadline in Spring. To continue to CP194, your average must be a 2.0 (Passing) or 1.7 at the lowest (recorded as “In Progress”), but your transcript grade for this course will be finalized after you submit your capstone (you receive one grade across CP193 and CP194).
- **CP194 (Year 4, Spring Semester, 4 credits).** Like the first semester of Year 4, you should expect to spend 12 hours per week on Capstone. During this semester you will finalize and defend your capstone.
- **CP195 (Year 4, May, 2 credits).** The finale of your capstone journey will be *Manifest* in which you take part in a variety of workshops, Capstone presentations, student-led classes, and discussions for 45 hours per week. Refer to the master calendar on myMinerva for dates. Most notably, you will design and teach a class pertaining to your Capstone project for your peers (general audience).

The CP193 & CP194 Weekly Calendar

Week	CP193 FALL	Week	CP194 SPRING
1	Advising group meeting	1	
2	**Project Brief** (5%)	2	Advising group meeting
3		3	
4	Advising group meeting	4	
5	Committee meetings	5	Advising group meeting
6*		6*	
7		7	**Revised Full Draft** (15%)
8	Advising group meeting **Midterm Deliverables** (10%)	8	Committee meetings — Oral Defenses
9		9	
10	1:1 check-ins	10	
11		11*	
12*		12	**Final Capstone** (50%)
13		13	Advising group meeting
14	**Full Draft** (20%)	14	
15	Committee meetings	15	

*Minerva holiday are: Fall weeks 6 and 12, Spring weeks 6 and 11

Your Capstone Group

Three times per semester, students will meet as a group for 45-90 minutes with their Capstone Advisor. The structure, content, and duration of group meetings may vary and might include:

- Student presentations and feedback
- Professor's feedback on students' working files
- Detailed peer feedback on work products
- Discussion of particular HC or LO applications and how to improve them
- Workshopping custom LO descriptions and rubrics
- Discussion of next steps, including planning to meet upcoming deadlines

- Discussion of work habits and processes, goal-setting, and project management
- Q&A with advisor
- Co-working

Note that group meetings are your main opportunity to discuss your project with your Capstone Advisor. *Plan ahead to make the most of this time!* Be sure to check the "Pre-Class Work" expectations for each group meeting and come prepared to participate fully.

Your Capstone Committee

Committee meetings provide students with opportunities for additional feedback as well as practice in presenting their project's aims and accomplishments.

- **Committee composition.** Capstone committee meetings include the student's advisor and a second Minerva professor (usually their second reader). Additional members can be included with the advisor's approval, for example an external mentor.
- **Second reader.** Every capstone has a second reader, and students indicate relevant Minerva faculty in their Project Brief (due Fall week 2). For interdisciplinary projects, we aim to assign a second reader whose expertise is complementary to that of the student's Capstone Advisor. Ideally, second readers are identified early in the Fall semester and serve on students' committees from the beginning. However, there are many constraints on the central matching process, and some matchings might be delayed.
- **Committee meetings.** You will have three committee meetings across your senior year, and it is your responsibility to schedule them. For more information about each of the three meetings, see the descriptions later in this document, as well as the even more detailed links each provides.

Your Capstone Assignments

- Fall Week 2: Project Brief (5%)
- Fall Week 8: Midterm Deliverables (10%)
- Fall Week 14: Full Draft (20%)
- Spring Week 7: Revised Full Draft (15%)
- Spring Week 12: Final Capstone (50%)

Here are some things to know about the Capstone Assignments:

- **Increasing Assignment Weights across Fall.** In Fall semester, each assignment is worth double the one before it). The semester starts with a *Project Brief* at just 5% where you make sure that you and your advisor have the same high-level vision for what your capstone process and product will be. The *Midterm Deliverable* expects a substantial amount of work for you and your advisor to discuss and is worth 10% of your final CP193/CP194 grade. By the end of the semester, you should have a working draft of your capstone worth 20% of your grade across the year.

- **Grading on Both Product and Process.** Across the year, you will receive scores and feedback on both what you produce (e.g., #qualitydeliverables) and the process by which you produce it (e.g., #navigation). This culminates in the grading of the final capstone, in which you submit both the work product and the process documentation, and for many capstones the process documentation will be larger than the work product!
- **Capstone assignments have FIRM deadlines.** Part of what you are demonstrating with your Year 4 project is your ability to manage your time on large projects that have firm deadlines. The ability to meet firm deadlines is an important skill in many real-world contexts (e.g., many professional contexts). You will generally have all of the information you need to complete an assignment weeks in advance of the deadline, and you are encouraged to submit assignments early. Here is one approach you might use (and talk about in your Process Documentation): for each assignment, have a complete version that you could submit 7 days before the deadline, then use 5 of the remaining days to improve parts of it to even higher quality, and then submit the assignment 2 days before the deadline. A final note is that all Capstone assignments have a 1-day submission window; 24 hours after the Due Date, you will not be able to submit your work on Forum. Failing to submit an assignment by the assignment's Close date will incur the usual penalties, 0 scores on all associated HCs and LOs.

Your Other Sources of Support

You should take the leading role in driving your capstone project forward, but you are not alone! In addition to your capstone advisor, capstone group, and capstone committee, sources of support will include:

- **Written Resources.** There are ways to consult written resources (Appendix A)
- **Human Resources.** and human resources (Appendix B) along your journey.
- **Research Ethics Committee.** If your capstone collects or uses information from people, then you will be required to consult with the research ethics committee at Minerva (Click here for additional information on projects involving people or their data).
- **Capstone Head Instructor.** Hello! I'm the Capstone Head Instructor, Professor Sheskin. Outside of Minerva, I'm just some person who enjoys playing strategy games, cooking with my family, and theatre. I want to chat with you about capstone! This can range from relaxed brainstorming, to you sharing concerns about your capstone advisor. I'm at msheskin@minerva.edu
- **CAPS.** Mental health is important! Too many countries and cultures have an expectation that you have regular doctor appointments (e.g., annual physical) for your body, but do not encourage doctor appointments for your mind! Chat with CAPS! caps@minerva.edu
- **Your real world social network.** Your peers at Minerva, your friends and family who aren't quite sure what an HC is, that person who volunteers alongside you at a nonprofit and you don't really like but you chat with a lot because they are *there*… your real world social network is important in general, and may also be a source of support in various ways as you work on capstone :)

CP193 Assignments (Fall)

Week 2: Project Brief

Weight: 5%
Due Date: Fall week 2, Saturday, UTC Time Zone (firm deadline, closes 1 day later)

Purpose:

Putting together this information will help you take an inventory of where you are now, and help you make good plans. Sharing them with your advisor will confirm that you and your advisor have the same high-level vision for what you are doing, and provide a foundation for feedback to shape and support your plans.

How to do this assignment:

- **Create your document.** Save a copy of the Project Brief Cover Sheet and work in your copy of this document.
- **Look over the instructions**. Take note of which parts will require the most time for you. For example, if you have not yet started on your "Plan for working ~12 hours per week" then that might require a lot of time for you to develop.
- **Look over the table**. Take note of which parts will require the most time for you. For example, you might realize that your "main folder" for your capstone is currently very disorganized, and you want to organize it before submitting this assignment, so that it is in good shape for you to use, and can be easily navigated by your capstone advisor when they first click on the link to it.
- **Look at Appendix A of this Handbook.** There are resources like lists of project management tools, templates for tracking HC use in different software, etc. You should look at these resources and decide which might be part of your process this year, and show up in this current assignment.
- **Think carefully about HC and LO use.** Remember, you need to include 15-25 HCs and 5-10 LOs from your major(s), with at least 2 from each major you have. For this assignment, you should briefly describe your intended use of each. For example, you might say "In my project I will apply #powerdynamics by identifying the sources of influence of 10 key agents in the organization, including agents who had low official power based on the organizational chart but high power based on other factors such as expertise or relationships" *even though you have not yet written that part of your capstone*. Over time, check that the description is as complete and accurate as possible, and make it clear what is planned vs. what you actually did. For *this* assignment, you do not have to list the Capstone LOs (#curation) but you can if you have good content you want to include for them.
- **Submit one PDF comfortably before the deadline.** Unless it is impossible for your project, you should submit one PDF that contains all of the information. Note that some information will appear in links *and* in your PDF. For example, you might have a Notion page where you

will update your HC/LOs over time, but you must *also* include the current version in the PDF of this assignment. Note also the wording in bold "comfortably before the deadline" because CP193 and CP194 deadlines are firm, and you will not even be able to upload your assignment to Forum more than a day late – you are encouraged to submit days *before* the deadline.

Assessment

All scores you receive on this assignment will be averaged together and that one number will be **5%** of your final grade applied to both CP193 and CP194. Here are likely scores:

- **Work Products:** The PDF you upload to Forum will receive a score on #qualitydeliverables, and will likely receive a score on an MC HC (perhaps #organization or #composition) for presenting the large amount of information in easy-to-understand ways. After your First Committee Meeting, another score on #qualitydeliverables will be added to *this* assignment to reflect your presentation and engagement at the committee meeting.
- **Process Documentation:** The PDF you upload to Forum will likely receive a score on *#outcomeanalysis* for the attention you pay to planning your use of HCs and LOs. After your committee meeting, a *#navigation* score will represent your overall plans about how you will approach completing your capstone work.

Week 5: First Committee Meeting

It is also okay for this to take place in week 6.

This will be a 30-minute meeting in which you present a slide deck for 5 to 10 minutes, with most of the time reserved for discussion. Assume that your second reader has no knowledge of your project yet (though it is possible they will have skimmed your project description in this sheet so make sure to update your entries in this form). Your presentation should provide a quick and clear overview of:

- What will be your main capstone work product? Who is the audience for it?
- What main approaches to #navigation do you plan to use?
- What are the most important HCs and LOs for your project?
- What work have you completed already?
- What are your short-term plans – what *exactly* will you be doing in the next 5 hours you work on capstone?
- Any other information your advisor has asked you to talk about.

For all meetings: Guidance for presentations here. Students take notes in a copy of this template during the meeting; then paste into this form.

Week 8: Midterm Deliverables

Weight: 10%
Due Date: Fall week 8, Saturday, UTC Time Zone (firm deadline, closes 1 day later)

Purpose: At the midpoint of the semester, you should have completed some part of your capstone work product that is substantial, and that can provide a **concrete** foundation for you and your committee to discuss what your final capstone will look like. For example, an AH student creating a podcast series might have a draft version of a single episode available for feedback, and an SS student designing an experiment with people might have the full experiment ready for the advisor to experience.

How to do this assignment:

- **Create your document.** Save a copy of the General Capstone Cover Sheet. Note that this file is slightly different from the Project Brief cover sheet.
- **Continuously document your process.** You will submit *Process Documentation* for your midterm deliverable *Work Product*. It is likely that a lot of this documentation will also appear in your final Capstone's *Process Documentation*. However, some of it will likely change as you continue to work.
    - For example, in this assignment, you might document how your work this past month has impacted your timeline for completing the rest of the capstone. You might revise your timeline again after submitting the next assignment, and include a presentation of that in the next Process Documentation as well. Your final Capstone *Process Documentation* would likely provide one integrated account of how you adapted your timeline across the year, rather than just pasting together the sections from each assignment.
- **Elicit lots of feedback from your advisor and others.** Your advisor (and other sources of feedback) should be aware of your plans and progress even before you submit this assignment, so that they can help guide you along the way. It is true that you will *also* get substantial feedback after this assignment, but nothing in it should be a big surprise to your advisor!
- **Follow advisor requirements.** Your advisor may require other content or particular formatting (e.g., spreadsheet of LO descriptions and rubrics).
- **Submit one PDF comfortably before the deadline.** As with the final Capstone, if your work product is not something that can easily appear in a PDF, then you should document and describe it, in addition to linking to anything relevant (e.g., your GitHub).

One final clarification here is that it is possible that your *Work Product* for this current Midterm Deliverable actually becomes part of your *Process Documentation* for your final Capstone. For example, perhaps the Midterm Deliverable is user experience testing of an app prototype, and this

leads to a pivot in the project such that the final app is very different! In that case, the *Work Product* from this assignment might end up being part of the *Process Documentation* of the final capstone.

Assessment

All scores you receive on this assignment will be averaged together and that one number will be **10%** of your final grade applied to both CP193 and CP194. Here are likely scores:

- **Work Products:** A score on #*qualitydeliverables***,** and likely 1-2 scores on the HCs/LOs that are most central to the work product you create.
- **Process:** A score on #navigation for your process documentation. Another likely score could be on how clearly you present your process documentation, for example #organization.

Week 14: Full Draft

Weight: 20%
Due: Fall week 14, Friday, UTC Time Zone (firm deadline, closes 1 day later)

Purpose:

For the first time in the capstone process, you will be required to upload a document with all of the sections you will have in the final capstone, from the title page to the HC/LO descriptions in the Process Documentation. For many students, there will be pieces that are not yet available. When a piece is not available, you should include the *plans* you have for that piece. Similar to the Project Brief at the start of the semester, this will allow you and your committee to have the same knowledge about exactly where you are now, and strategize about your plans for finalization.

How to do this assignment:

- **Create your document.** Save a copy of the General Capstone Cover Sheet.
- **Add placeholders for *all* parts of your final capstone.** Take another look at what is included in the final capstone, from Executive Summary to Process Documentation. Compile all of the information you already have for these, even if that is nothing (e.g., you might have a page that just has the heading "Executive Summary" but no content yet). One approach can be to make sure that any heading (subheading, etc.) that would appear in your table of contents appears in this document, even if you don't have any content for it yet.
- **Regularly communicate with your advisor about expectations.** For example, perhaps your advisor is okay with the *Executive Summary* staying blank for this draft, or for its content being described but not included. One approach you and your advisor *might* follow can be to put "narration" about intended content in brackets, like this:
    - [For my executive summary, I think I will include Fig. 5 from my main paper, and focus on explaining the main effect I got between the two conditions of my experiment]

    - [In this part of my Introduction chapter, I will spend about two pages reviewing the academic debate on whether monkeys care about fairness. In total, I will probably cite around 20 papers, focusing especially on Martinez and Brosnan, 2025; and Schweinfurth and Call, 2021]
    - [The below 750 words are an MVP of my discussion of the user experience testing I did for my app; depending on how much time I have and what we think is a priority, I might improve this a lot. One thing I could do is include more quotes from the users, and more explanation of how I changed things based on what they said.]
- **Submit one PDF comfortably before the deadline.** It is very important that you not receive a 0 on this assignment worth 20% of your grade across the semester. You should submit your assignment early, so that it is not late.

Assessment

All scores you receive on this assignment will be averaged together and that one number will be **20%** of your final grade applied to both CP193 and CP194. Here are likely scores:

- **Work Products:** Two scores on #*qualitydeliverables***,** one for the draft of the capstone work product, and another for your presentation and engagement at the committee meeting soon after. You will also likely receive approximately 5 additional HC/LO scores related to the content in your capstone work product.
- **Process Documentation:** You will receive at least one "overall" score on #*navigation* for the capstone process documentation. You will receive at least one score on on #*outcomeanalysis* for the HC/LO descriptions and your reflection on them. Another likely score is #*organization* for clearly presenting information in sections of your process documentation – for example, you might decide to split your HC/LO descriptions into three subsections of *Completed Applications* and *In-progress Applications* and *Planned HCs and LOs*. After your committee meeting, a second #*navigation* score will represent your overall plans about how you will approach completing your capstone work.

Week 15: Second Committee Meeting

This will be a 30-minute meeting in which you present a slide deck for about 10 minutes, with most of the time reserved for discussion. Your advisor and second reader are interested in your progress and what is left to be completed next semester. Assume that your second reader has, *at most*, skimmed your Full Draft for 1-5 minutes.Your presentation should provide a quick and clear overview of:

- Compared to earlier in the semester, has anything changed about your planned work product?
- What work have you completed already? What are you particularly proud of?
- What work do you still have to complete? Are there any parts you are concerned about completing?

- What parts of your #navigation have been going well, and what do you want to change for next semester?
- What is your timeline for completing the work?
- What are your short-term plans – what *exactly* will you be doing in the next 5 hours you work on capstone?
- Any other information your advisor has asked you to talk about.

For all meetings: Guidance for presentations here. Students take notes in a copy of this template during the meeting; then paste into this form.

CP194 Assignments (Spring)

Week 7: Revised Full Draft

Weight: 15%
Due Date: Spring week 7, Saturday, UTC Time Zone (firm deadline, closes 1 day later)

Purpose:

This draft of your Capstone should include improvements to your earlier draft, such as additional content and analysis, clearer organization, and highly polished presentation of all materials. It should clearly address the feedback you have received on earlier work products. Keep in mind that you will need to work quickly to implement upcoming feedback from your committee and complete all of the finishing touches on this draft in time for the Final Capstone submission.

How to do this assignment:

- You will update the Full Draft document you submitted at the end of last semester, including updates to the cover sheet.
- You should make sure to call your advisor's attention to the parts you have worked on the most, especially how you have implemented the work that was planned between the last assignment and this one. The exact details for how you do this (how much is described in the cover sheet, versus indicated in an obvious way in the main text, versus described in the Process Documentation) is up to you and your advisor. In general, you should have more content that you did before, including more Process Documentation than you did before, but exactly how you indicate what is *new* will depend on the specifics of your capstone.

Assessment

All scores you receive on this assignment will be averaged together and that one number will be **15%** of your final grade applied to both CP193 and CP194. Here are likely scores:

- **Work Products:** Two scores on #*qualitydeliverables***,** one for the draft of the capstone work product, and another for your oral defense soon after. The score on the written document

will reflect (1) whether you have substantially increased the quality and completeness of the content since the first Full Draft, and (2) whether you are on track for the final iteration of your capstone by the deadline. The score on the defense will focus on the quality of the presentation – think especially of HCs from Multimodal Communications. You may receive additional content scores on HCs or LOs, especially new applications added after the last assignment.

- **Process Documentation:** You will receive at least one "overall" score on *#navigation* for the capstone process documentation. You will receive at least one score on on *#outcomeanalysis* for the HC/LO descriptions and your reflection on them. Another likely score is *#organization* for clearly presenting information in sections of your process documentation. For example, you might decide to split your HC/LO descriptions into three subsections of *Completed Applications* and *In-progress Applications* and *Planned Applications*. After your committee meeting, a second *#navigation* score will represent your overall plans about how you will approach completing your capstone work.

Week 8: Capstone Oral Defense

It is also okay for this to be in Week 9.

This will be a 30-minute meeting in which you present a slide deck for about 10 minutes, then field questions from the committee for about 15 minutes, wait for a bit while your committee chats without you, and then learn whether you have passed or not. Passing the defense is required to pass capstone, and so if you do not pass you will need to schedule a second attempt.

Click here for a separate document that details scheduling the defense, preparing for it, and succeeding during it.

For all meetings: Guidance for presentations here. Students take notes in a copy of this template during the meeting; then paste into this form.

Week 12: Final Capstone

Weight: 50%
Due Date: Spring Week 12, Saturday, UTC Time Zone (firm deadline, closes 1 day later)

You should upload one PDF with:

- A title page
- The executive summary
- The academic abstract
- Your capstone work product
- Your capstone process documentation

For details about the items in this list, see Four Parts of a Minerva Capstone above.

CP195 Manifest Assignments (May)

Please refer to the Manifest Handbook for information.

Appendices

Appendix A. Supporting information

Information, templates, and related resources

M26 Capstone Google group	Announcements and updates will be logged here.
Capstone Learning Outcomes	Descriptions and guiding questions for strong applications
List of project management tools	Tools and systems recommended by Minervans; see especially the Zotero quick-start guide!
Guidelines for writing custom LO descriptions and rubrics	Follow these guidelines if you are writing or considering custom LOs for your Capstone. → Custom LOs should be drafted in the fall semester. Custom LOs must be reviewed (and approved) by the end of week 7 in the spring semester.
LOs from Cores and Concentrations	Compiled and maintained by students, with links to syllabi and rubrics
HC resources: on myMinerva, HC Handbook, Cornerstone Custom HC Guides, Study Kit pages, one-page list of the HCs grouped by competency	Refer to the documents provided on the HC Hub page for information and advice regarding how to effectively apply and justify the use of HCs and LOs in your work.
Library resources	For finding and accessing scholarly resources
Optional templates Documenting HC/LOs use: HC/LO Template 1 w/ Gantt chart HC/LO Template 2 HC & LO trackers in Notion Planning and accountability templates: For individual use For groups (option 1) For groups (option 2)	Tracking HC and LO applications is expected; use whatever format works well for you (Notion, Docs, Sheets, paper journal). Some spreadsheet templates are provided here. The first template also includes other planning tools (e.g., Gantt chart, network list). Tracking progress on a daily or weekly basis is helpful. Template spreadsheets are provided here; some students may prefer apps or paper journals (suggestions are compiled here: Tools and systems for project management).

🍿 Starting your process 🍿 All things feedback 🍿 Tools to streamline writing	Tips!

Requirements for projects involving people or data derived from people

If your intended project might involve the collection or analysis of information from living individuals, carefully review the entire Undergraduate Human Subjects Research at Minerva document. Follow all of the required steps by the stated deadlines. Contact Minerva's HSR committee (hsr@minerva.edu) if you have any questions that are not addressed in the provided documentation.

Example Capstone projects, abstracts, and prospectuses

Refer to the spreadsheets below for further information and for links to the available items. We are moving toward a searchable database (Coming soon!). Examples, including common project types, are linked from MyMinerva.

- M19 Capstone projects and abstracts
- M20 Capstone projects and abstracts
- M21 Capstone projects
- M22 Capstone projects
- M23 Capstone projects
- M24 Capstone projects
- M25 Capstone project descriptions

Appendix B. Support for students

Expert advice, critique, and feedback

Every student is responsible for identifying and contacting people who can serve as experts for one or more aspects of their project. Such field-specific experts will not be paid. The purpose of identifying and working with experts (e.g., internship managers, Civic Partners, professional contacts) is to ensure that students' work respects the existing knowledge of, and is original within and additive to, their field(s). An external expert's engagement may vary from one hour to regular interaction over an entire year.

Capstone Advisors

Minerva faculty Capstone Advisors have overlapping interests or experience with the topics or approaches of the projects they advise, but they are **not expected to have deep expertise pertaining to any given Capstone project**. Capstone Advisors serve four primary roles:

1. To evaluate their advisees' completed Capstone project proposals, submitted at the end of CP192 Capstone Seminar (Spring semester), including the topic, approach, LOs to be applied, and intended deliverables,

2. To meet with advisees regularly throughout CP193 & CP194 Capstone Directed Study to help ensure that projects are on track for successful completion by the designated deadlines,
3. To provide formative feedback when possible and to grade their advisees' Capstone work products during CP193 & CP194 Capstone Directed Study and CP195 Manifest, and
4. To serve as a second reader for other students' projects, sitting on capstone committees and contributing to the grading of the Final Capstone.

Minerva events and coaching

Several teams, including Academic, Coaching and Talent Development, and Student Life, have collaborated to design opportunities and events — such as focused work sessions, workshops, and talks — to support students' Capstone progress. These opportunities will be announced to all students through the relevant Portal groups.

Workshops and AMAs

Watch for announcements. Topics might include:

- Maximizing group and committee meetings
- Seeking and applying relevant feedback
- Using helpful tools (e.g., Zotero, time-tracking, journals)
- Getting unstuck
- Designing and giving effective presentations
- Giving effective feedback
- College-specific advice — e.g., norms of professional presentation

Professor office hours

Students may show up to office hours and/or request to meet with Minerva faculty regarding specific aspects of their Capstones. For information about faculty expertise and interests, refer to this spreadsheet. Professors' office hours information is listed on Forum.

Peer support

Finding the time to work on Capstones (~12 hours per week) is one of the greatest challenges that students face. Many alumni have reported that they greatly benefitted from participating in coworking sessions. While some coworking sessions may occasionally be set up by faculty or staff, students are encouraged to set up and run their own coworking sessions, either in-person (if feasible) or virtually.

You may enter the details of any open coworking sessions in this spreadsheet (tabs for summer, fall, and spring) and then spread the word through Portal, Facebook, Telegram, and other relevant platforms.

Mentoring and other support

Some Minerva alumni are interested in supporting students during their Capstone process! More details will be added here when available.

Students are welcome to request or suggest specific types of support — please email the Capstone Head Instructor (ahadavand@minerva.edu).

Appendix C. Frequently asked questions (FAQs)

Intellectual property (IP) and partnering with external people/organizations

Q: Who owns the intellectual property associated with my Capstone project?

When a project is led by the student without substantial collaborators, the intellectual property belongs to the student. The list of "collaborators" who might limit the scope of student ownership include the capstone advisor, project collaborators, project funders, and external organizations the student partners with. To be clear, for capstones done with just a Minerva faculty advisor and no external collaborator, most projects end up being the intellectual property of the student. However, if a student's Capstone is based on a faculty-suggested subject, the student must consult with the faculty member prior to publishing the work (or any related work) to determine the role of the faculty member in advising and/or co-authoring the publication. Likewise, when a professional invites you to collaborate with them on their ongoing professional activities (whether a Minerva professor or an external advisor), the primary IP owner may be the professional whose long-standing activity you are joining for a short time. When in doubt, you should discuss this topic sooner rather than later!

Q: My Capstone project pertains to proprietary work that I am doing at a company. For legal reasons, the company does not want certain information shared with anyone who has not signed a non-disclosure agreement (NDA). Can my work be restricted to those who first sign an NDA?

No. Minerva faculty, staff, and students will *not* sign an NDA for the sake of official Capstone proceedings. The abstract and prospectus will be made public and therefore should not contain any IP. The lesson plan that students generate and the class recordings will not be public, nor will be the defense. It is the student's responsibility that all information contained in Capstone materials is legally allowed to be presented for all uses intended at Manifest (e.g. Capstone submission, class taught on Forum). The Capstone project will not be made public without students' permission; however these projects will be searchable and visible within Minerva (by staff, faculty, students, and alumni with Minerva accounts) unless a student demonstrates a valid reason for restricting access or redacting small parts. Any and all grades and feedback are protected by FERPA regulations.

Q: Can my project be completed in coordination with a person or organization outside of Minerva?

Yes, though there are both benefits and costs to this. Students should be aware of possible constraints that might arise and should make contingency plans accordingly. Typically, working with an outside organization (e.g., research group, business, non-profit) increases a student's access to relevant experts and resources and can lead to a rewarding Capstone experience. Note that your

individual contribution to the project should be seen as significant by your advisor and second reader. Unfortunately, such partnerships can dissolve unexpectedly, so all students are required to have an approved Capstone proposal for a project that can be completed without any substantial external dependencies, such as access to specialized resources (e.g., datasets, internal reports, IRB approval for human subjects research) through an organization in case a sudden change of direction is needed.

Money, payment, stipends

Q: Can I be paid for work that is my Capstone project or leads to my Capstone project?

Yes. There are no restrictions on getting paid for Capstone work *unless* that payment comes with conditions that limit your ability to fulfill all of your responsibilities for Manifest (e.g. Capstone submission, abstract, executive summary, class taught on Forum, and prospectus if applicable).

Q: Can I request or apply for monetary support from Minerva for my Capstone project?

No, there are no financial resources available within Minerva to support student projects. Accordingly, some students may find it beneficial to apply for external funding or collaborate with outside organizations (e.g., laboratories, non-profits, or companies). Such partnerships will likely bring added resources, but may also add constraints. Keep in mind that students — not external experts or partner organizations — are expected to drive the focus of, and progress on, their Capstone projects. Students will continue to have access to scholarly resources through our library consortium. If additional resources or funding are required, these will be up to individuals to procure (e.g., through grants or donations).

LOs, grading, and graders

Q: How long should my capstone be to get a good grade?

Professional work is often characterized by keeping within word *limits* rather than surpassing word *minimums*. For example, an academic journal may specify a maximum article length of 4,000 words, and authors may spend significant time with #curation and #composition to fit all of their work within that limit. As a concrete example, the 1953 paper suggesting the double helix shape of DNA (very important and a massive amount of work!!) fits on a single PDF page. For Minerva capstone projects, we expect substantial differences in word count, especially for the *Work Product*: a student writing a full-length novel might have a work product that is twenty times the length of the work product from a student drafting a "Short Report" of an empirical study for the journal *Developmental Science* (word_limit_4000). However, both students would have large and carefully constructed *Process Documentation* and both projects (a novel and an empirical study) would be year-long endeavors of professional quality.

Q: When LOs from prior courses are scored in CP193 and/or CP194, what impact does this have on prior course grades?

Scores on LOs in the context of your Capstone project will have no impact on the grades of courses where those LOs were introduced.

Q: Where can I find descriptions and rubrics for LOs from past courses?

From the Outcome Index, click on the "Courses" tab, then use the dropdown menu to view the course objectives, learning outcomes, and rubrics associated with courses in any semester. Students have been maintaining a list of LOs (hashtags and descriptions, but not rubrics) from Core and Concentration courses in this sheet (also listed in Appendix A), with links to current course syllabi in a second tab.

Q: If the LO I learned in a course has been updated, must I use the updated version?

For any LOs from courses, you may choose the version that seems best suited to your project. Take the opportunity to look at the revised version before deciding. (*This is unlike HCs* — everyone will be graded on the current version of the HCs. Related resources: HC Succession map and HC changes at the bottom of this page.)

Q: Are custom LOs required? May I use custom LOs exclusively?

Custom LOs are *not* required, but may be appropriate; the project dictates whether to use custom LOs and, if so, how many. Refer to these guidelines for suggestions.

Q: Who are the graders for our various Capstone assignments and Manifest deliverables?

Your Capstone Advisor is the primary grader on all Capstone and Manifest work products, including the class that you lead during Manifest. At all stages of the Capstone process, Capstone Advisors can and do reach out to one another to discuss the feedback and scores on their advisees' work. When needed, Advisors also request grading guidance from other professors who have taught courses from which students' LOs are derived. For both the Final Capstone and the oral defense, a second reader also participates directly in the assessment. The Advisor and second reader discuss and reach agreement on the scores and comments provided — there is only one set of scores on the assignments.

Q: When will we receive the final set of scores and feedback on our projects?

Likely during the week after finals, which is also the week before the start of Manifest. Capstone scores and comments will be released to all students on the same day in late April, as soon as the grading process is complete.

Q: I don't see many comments on my Final Capstone. What does this mean? Can I ask for more information?

This is to be expected. Although some students may see more comments, Capstone Advisors were asked to provide an overarching comment and a full set of scores. As this was the final assessment stage in the Capstone process, the emphasis was on determining and confirming the appropriate set of scores rather than providing formative feedback, which had been the focus for prior assignments and committee meetings. You can be confident that your Advisor and second reader carefully considered your work and the HCs and LOs that you applied. In most cases a third professor also reviewed your project and the associated scores to assure consistency across projects.

Most professors will not have time to offer additional feedback prior to graduation. They have a short grading timeline for their Spring semester courses and then move directly on to supporting students and quickly grading assignments and classes during Manifest. Many are also helping with Consequent and other Graduation-related events.

Q: If I have questions about scores or feedback on my Final Capstone, or I want to request that a score or set of scores be reconsidered, what are my options?

If you have identified a mistake in scoring (e.g., the wrong HC was selected and scored), you can inform your advisor, who can make the change directly if they agree that there was a clerical error. If you would like more feedback or wish to discuss next steps for your project, you can request to set up a meeting with your Advisor, but please go in with the expectation that such a meeting might not be possible until after graduation. For scoring disputes (apart from clerical errors), please use the Disputed Grade Petition Form form found on the registrar site (https://registrar.minerva.edu/) to request reconsideration of any scores on your Final Capstone. If you choose this approach, please note:

- The entire Final Capstone will be reviewed again by the original graders (advisor, second reader, and in many cases a third professor) as well as by a College Head, Dean or Provost who was not previously involved in the project's assessment.
- Upon submitting a grade dispute, *all* scores are subject to revision — not only those specified in the grade dispute — and therefore any scores may go up, go down, or stay the same. Given the tremendous care and attention that multiple professors have put into evaluating Capstones and providing accurate assessments and feedback, it is most common that scores will not change.
- The results of this additional review are final.
- Upon receiving a disputed grade petition, the review process may take up to 3 weeks.

Committees and committee meetings

Q: May I include other people at my committee meetings?

It depends; check with your advisor. In most cases, an extra person will be welcome, provided that they can attend at a time that is also convenient for your advisor and second reader. Remember that it is a good idea to reach out to many different people for feedback over the course of your project — professors, external experts, mentors, etc.

Q: My second reader isn't available for an upcoming committee meeting. What happens next?

Follow the guidelines provided in the supplemental committee information document. Work quickly so that you can schedule a meeting within the designated time frame.

Other logistics

Q: Can I count my Business Practicum experience as hours toward my Capstone?

You can develop aspects of your Capstone during your Practicum over the summer. However, you will need to spend, on average, 12 hours per week during the academic year building this into a final Capstone project that will be evaluated for its quality in the final semester and during Manifest.

Q: Can I use work that I completed for a Tutorial, Concentration, or other course in my Capstone? Is that self-plagiarism?

You can build on work you completed in other settings (e.g., Tutorial) to support your Capstone. In your Capstone you must cite when and in what setting this work was first generated (e.g., this chapter is based on work I did in [XYZ tutorial], submitted on [date]). You should revise the content and format of the completed work so that it is of an appropriately ambitious scope and is appropriately incorporated in your Capstone.

You may not repurpose work in the other direction (e.g., write a chapter for your Capstone in the fall and then submit that same work for a Concentration or Tutorial assignment in the spring).

Q: Can I complete my Capstone project early (for example, if I have an internship over the summer that will help me achieve many of my Capstone project objectives)?

Yes. The deadlines for submission are true deadlines. If completed earlier, work can be submitted as soon as submission procedures are in place.

Q: My intended project involves using source materials or creating products in a language other than English. What are the expectations related to translating materials into English?

All submitted materials must be available in English for your Capstone Advisor and second reader to evaluate. If you create materials in another language, English translations are required.

Source materials in non-English languages can be used and referenced; however, you must provide English translations of all citations and may need to provide translations of specific materials if requested by your Capstone Advisor or second reader. For citations that receive only a brief reference in your capstone, an English-language summary (e.g., what you might see in an annotated bibliography) might be sufficient.

Q: Can I request for extensions on any of the capstone assignments?

No. For a full explanation, see the section in the main document about capstone deadlines.

Q: Can some of my capstone be shared with the Minerva community (or even publicly) but not *all* of it?

Yes. For example, perhaps there is some personal information about your process that you do not want to share publicly, perhaps how you addressed a particular challenge in your personal life that

was interfering with your progress. You should arrange to have a partially redacted version archived instead of the full version; please contact your capstone advisor about this.

Appendix D. Details of Grading and Policies

Grading

At the end of Spring, you will receive one grade across both semesters (CP193 and CP194). This grade will add together your scores on the assignments across the year, according to their weights.

- Fall Week 2: Project Brief (5%)
- Fall Week 8: Midterm Deliverables (10%)
- Fall Week 14: Full Draft (20%)
- Spring Week 7: Revised Full Draft (15%)
- Spring Week 12: Final Capstone (50%)

For example, imagine that you received these four scores on the *Project Brief*: 3, 3, 4, 4. The math is not influenced by which HC or LO was tagged for each, they are simply averaged to become a 3.5. This average is then combined with the weight of the *Project Brief* (5%) to enter the calculation at the end of the year as (3.5*0.05).

Here is what the full math might look like for a student, plugging in the simple average of the scores they received on each assignment: (3.5*0.05)+(3.7*0.10)+(3.2*0.20)+(4.1*0.15)+(4.2*0.50)=3.9

Note: At the end of Fall, you can only proceed to Spring semester if you have a score that is directed towards passing. Specifically, if you have an average of 2.0 or higher you will have a temporary Fall grade of “Pass”. If you have an between 1.7 and 2.0 will be IP (in progress) and you may be required to submit revised work by an early date in January (with sufficient improvement on that work being required for enrollment in CP194). An average lower than 1.7 will receive a grade of “NP” (no pass) and will have to repeat CP193 the following academic year, before taking CP194, both of which can be completed remotely. Keeping in mind that only **35%** of the weight occurs in assignments in Fall, here is the math for an example passing grade for CP193:
(2.2*0.5)+(2.1*0.10)+(2.7*0.20)/**0.35**=2.853

Even though the HCs and LOs that are tagged do *not* influence the math, they carry information about how to improve. For example, you might receive a low score on a particular HC in an early assignment, and focus on improving it in the next assignment, or you might see you are in general getting better scores on scores applied to your *Product* than on scores applied to your *Process* and work more on *Process* and its documentation.

When an HC or LO score does not have a comment, you can assume it is roughly following the following rubric:

HC/LO Score	Meaning
0	Missing, penalty score, or otherwise lower than a 1
1	Inaccurate and/or largely incomplete application for a Capstone-sized project
2	Somewhat inaccurate or somewhat incomplete application for a Capstone-sized project
3	Accurate and complete application, suitable for a Capstone-sized project, with appropriate justification and/or analysis
4	Accurate, complete, and sophisticated application, suitable for a Capstone-sized project, with strong accompanying justification and/or analysis
5	Accurate, complete, sophisticated, and unanticipated application with strong analysis and/or justification (comparable to Master's level or professionally publishable work)

Policies

The deadlines listed below for CP193 and CP194 are firm. Similarly, preparation for and active participation in all group meetings, committee meetings, and 1:1 meetings is required. Absences or late work that are not the result of documented extenuating circumstances will result in lowered HC and/or LO scores on assignments.

Remember that you are capable of completing your Capstone project and that you have a strong network all around you, including counselors, your coach, peers, friends, professors, family, and external mentors. Students who find themselves falling behind should reach out for necessary support. Examples and reminders are given in Appendix B. If you aren't sure where to start, please reach out to the Capstone Head Instructor or your Capstone Advisor.

Students who fail to generate sufficient work products and/or fall substantially behind in their progress will be referred to the Capstone Progress Review committee, composed of the Capstone Head Instructor, the Dean, and one or more content experts they confer with (likely a professor familiar with many projects, preferably in the student's major/college, but who is not the student's advisor). This committee may recommend follow-up measures and consequences, up to and including withdrawal from CP193 and/or CP194. Withdrawal would require the student to enroll in Capstone Directed Study and Manifest in the following academic year.

Refer to the full set of Policies in the syllabus in Forum.

Appendix E. Updates to this document

Consequential updates will be announced through the M26-capstone mailing list. Updates to this document during the academic year will be integrated into the relevant section and listed by date here:

- **9 November 2025**. An inconsistency has been corrected! In "The Two-year Capstone process" there was an old reference to a 2.5 being required to continue from CP193 to CP194. This disagreed with "Appendix D. Details of Grading and Policies" that said "At the end of Fall, you can only proceed to Spring semester if you have a score that is directed towards passing. Specifically, if you have an average of 2.0 or higher you will have a temporary Fall grade of "Pass", between 1.7 and 2.0 will be IP (in progress), and lower than 1.7 will receive a grade of "NP" (no pass) and will have to repeat CP193 the following academic year, before taking CP194, both of which can be completed remotely." The 1.7 is the correct number, and so the 2.5 has been changed. The 1.7 for "IP" and 2.0 for "P" reflect the updated rubrics (with a 0) for AY25-26, and are also consistent with the cutoffs for Foundation Year sequences (the thresholds for Fall semester to continue onto Spring in Year 1).
- **11 November 2025.** An inconsistency has been corrected! There is different information in various capstone resources about whether you need five LOs from your major (or 2+3 if you have two majors), or if you need five "LOs from any college" with a minimum of 2 from each major you have. Text in this handbook now reflects the more flexible requirement (and you can email msheskin@minerva.edu if you find any old information in M26-facing resources). The handbook now says this correct information in a section above:
    - [Your capstone will need] 5 LOs from any of the colleges. You must use 2 LOs from each major you have. If you have multiple majors, you need at least 2 from each. Custom LOs do count towards this total. For example, a BZ major would need at least 2 from the BZ college, plus 3 others (from BZ or any other college); a BZ and AH major would need at least 2 from BZ and at least 2 from AH, and 1 from any college (BZ, AH, or any other college).
- **12 December 2025.** Fixed a broken link to "all things feedback" video
- **10 January 2026.** Even more detail added to the section updated on 9 November 2025.